DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES

Office of the Secretary

Assistant Secretary for Administration
HHS EEO Office
Washington, DC 20201

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT LETTER
Transmittal via E-mail:

kdturnage@protonmail.com (Personal email)

February 10, 2026

Mr. Kevin D. Turnage
1003 E. Pinto Ct.
Gilbert, AZ 85296

Re: Kevin D. Turnage v. HHS
Agency File No.: HHS-HHS-0614-2023
Date Filed Formal: March 7, 2024

Dear Mr. Turnage:

This is to acknowledge receipt of the above-referenced discrimination complaint filed on March 7, 2024, against the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), Indian Health Service (IHS), Phoenix Indian Medical Center (PIMC). Please refer to the Agency File Number listed above in all correspondence related to this matter.

Your complaint will be processed pursuant to the Complaint Regulations outlined in Title 29 Code of Federal Regulations (C.F.R.) Part 1614.

You will be notified concerning which claim(s) are accepted for processing or dismissed. You will also be notified of applicable appeal rights. If additional information is needed to clarify the above-referenced complaint, you will be contacted by the Complaints Branch Chief.

The investigation of this complaint must be completed within 180 calendar days unless you have submitted an amendment or agreed in writing to extend the time period for the investigation. If you have not received the Report of Investigation (ROI) within 180 calendar days from the filing date of the stated complaint, you may request a hearing and decision from the EEOC or an immediate final decision from the Department.

In the absence of a complaint amendment or agreed-upon extension, you have the right to file a civil action after 180 calendar days from the date of filing an individual or class complaint if an appeal has not been filed and final action has not been taken. If your complaint has been amended, the investigation shall be completed within the earlier of 180 calendar days after the last amendment to the complaint or 360 calendar days after the filing of the original complaint, except

that you may request a hearing from the EEOC on a consolidated complaint any time after 180 calendar days from the date of the first filed complaint.

You must keep this office, Equal Employment Opportunity (HHS EEO), informed of all current mailing addresses and telephone numbers. Failure to keep us informed may cause a delay in processing the complaint or lead to a dismissal.

You are encouraged to submit all documents electronically via email to your assigned case manager. If it is necessary to mail documents, all correspondence should be mailed to:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
Office of Equal Employment Opportunity (HHS EEO)
Hubert H. Humphrey Building
HHS EEO
200 Independence Ave. SW, Room 308B
Washington, D.C. 20201
Fax Number: (202) 619-0823

If you have any questions or concerns, please contact Daisy Christopher, Formal Team Lead, at Daisy.Christopher@hhs.gov or (202) 240-3149.

Sincerely,

MICHAEL BELLINGER JR -S

Digitally signed by MICHAEL BELLINGER JR -S
Date: 2026.02.10 15:11:32 -05'00'

For: Daisy Christopher
Formal Team Lead
Office of Equal Employment Opportunity,
U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

PLAINTIFF'S EXHIBIT
1